

SAM.gov Registration

Worksheet Pack

Companion to the book 'The SAM.gov Registration Handbook: Entity validation, UEI, CAGE, and the mistakes that cost weeks'.

This is a private study aid. It is not a government form, it is not an official document, and filling it in does not register anything.

You register only at sam.gov, and it is free: registration, renewal, your UEI and your CAGE code. Nobody needs to charge you for any of it, and the government will never email or call you to sell registration help.

These are the fill-in tools from the book, on paper, where you can actually use them. Print this pack and keep it with your formation documents.

Work through them in order. Each one corresponds to a chapter, and the chapter explains why the worksheet asks what it asks. Most of the expensive mistakes in this process are ones a checklist cannot warn you about; the chapters can.

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What is in here

1. Pre-flight list - what to have open before you sit down
2. The canonical string - both source rows, and which system checks which
3. Document checklist - what each document proves, and what it does not
4. Timeline tracker - dates, so you can see which wait you are in
5. Renewal calendar - set it the day you go Active
6. Is this letter from the government? - four questions, in order
7. Your state, your entity type - the half of this that is not federal

Rules change. Check the date on the book's copyright page, and the book's links page, before relying on anything here.

1. Pre-flight list

The registration is one sitting if everything is open before you start. Tick each item. See Chapters 3 and 6.

Signed in and ready

- ☐ Login.gov account exists, second factor set up, and you are signed in
- ☐ A monitored email address is the one on the Login.gov account
- ☐ Worksheet 2 (the canonical string) filled in and open beside you

Files open, named so a stranger can tell what they are

- ☐ Certified copy of the articles of organization / incorporation (PDF)
- ☐ IRS EIN letter, CP 575 or 147C (PDF)
- ☐ Most recent state annual report, if the entity has filed one (PDF)
- ☐ Fictitious-name (DBA) registration, ONLY if you use a DBA

Numbers on paper

- ☐ EIN, as printed on the IRS letter
- ☐ The EIN's issue date, and the date two weeks after it
- ☐ Bank ACH routing number (not wire) and account number, from the bank in writing
- ☐ Primary NAICS code and its size standard; secondary codes
- ☐ Formation date (the EFFECTIVE date, if the filing shows two)

Decisions made

- ☐ Registration purpose: All Awards (unless you will never bid on a contract)
- ☐ Public search: stay in, or opt out (Chapter 10 - HUBZone and 8(a) require in)
- ☐ Who holds the Electronic Business point of contact (normally you)

If the EIN is less than two weeks old, submit entity validation now and stop before the taxpayer section. The IRS match will fail on a new EIN.

2. The canonical string

Two official records hold your name and address, and they may not match. Copy each EXACTLY as printed. From now on, paste from this page and never retype. See Chapter 4.

Row 1 - as the IRS letter prints it (use for SAM.gov)

Legal business name

Street

Unit / Suite

City, State, ZIP+4

Keep the IRS's abbreviations and capitalization even if they look wrong to you. SAM's taxpayer check compares against this record.

Row 2 - as the state record shows it (use for the bank)

Legal business name

Street

Unit / Suite

City, State, ZIP

If the two rows differ by more than formatting (a different street, an old address), stop and fix the wrong record before continuing.

Dates and identifiers

Formation date (effective)

State of incorporation

Fiscal year end

EIN

Taxpayer name (per CP 575)

Issued by the process - fill in as they arrive

Validation reference no.

UEI

CAGE code

Active date

Expiration (Active + 365)

Which system checks which row

- ☐ SAM entity validation - Row 1 (then your uploaded documents)
- ☐ SAM taxpayer check - Row 1, exactly
- ☐ Bank account title - Row 2; ask them to type it as Row 1 anyway
- ☐ SAM EFT section - the bank's account title, character for character
- ☐ Any later SBA certification - both, against each other

3. Document checklist

Gather these once, as PDFs, named clearly. The right-hand note says what the document is for, and the important ones say what it is NOT for. See Chapter 5 and Appendix A.

- ☐ Certified copy of the articles - Entity validation: proves all four facts. Bank.
- ☐ IRS EIN letter (CP 575 / 147C) - Entity validation: name + address. Taxpayer name. Bank.
- ☐ Most recent state annual report - Entity validation: name, address, state.
- ☐ Certificate of Status / Good Standing (< 60 days) - Bank. Validation: name and date ONLY - it prints no address.
- ☐ Business bank statement (< 5 years) - Entity validation: name + address, if the state documents fall short.
- ☐ Utility bill in the business name (< 5 years) - Entity validation: address. Water, gas or electric only.
- ☐ Fictitious-name (DBA) registration - Only if the DBA field is populated. Otherwise leave that field EMPTY.
- ☐ Executed operating agreement / bylaws - Bank. Later certifications. Not on GSA's validation list.
- ☐ Bank's ACH routing + account number, in writing - SAM Financial Information section.
- ☐ Photo identification - Bank.
- ☐ Beneficial-ownership information - Bank completes it with you. Nothing in SAM asks for it.

GSA's rule: at least one upload must show the full legal name AND the current physical address together. Upload two documents even when one would do; a rejection costs days and a second upload costs seconds.

4. Timeline tracker

Fill in dates as you go. The point is to see which wait you are in, and whose clock it runs on. See Chapter 3 and Appendix C.

Entity filed / effective date	_____	<i>The state</i>
Certified copy of articles ordered	_____	<i>Order it WITH the filing</i>
EIN issued	_____	<i>Save the CP 575 PDF now</i>
EIN + 14 days	_____	<i>IRS: 'wait up to 2 weeks' for TIN matching</i>
Bank: application submitted	_____	
Bank: documents uploaded	_____	<i>Check the dashboard to-do list</i>
Bank: interview / call completed	_____	
Bank: account open, ACH routing in hand	_____	
SAM: entity validation submitted	_____	<i>Do NOT wait for the EIN to age</i>
SAM: validation reference number	_____	<i>Write it here:</i>
Worry date (submission + 4 business days)	_____	<i>Then open a service desk case</i>
SAM: validation cleared, UEI assigned	_____	<i>GSA: 1.5-3.5 business days</i>
SAM: taxpayer section passed the IRS match	_____	
SAM: all sections complete, submitted	_____	
SAM: ACTIVE, CAGE assigned	_____	<i>SAM.gov: 'up to 10 business days'</i>
Expiration date written in the calendar	_____	<i>Active + 365 days</i>

Business days, not calendar days. A Friday-night submission starts its clock on Monday. If the worry date passes with no change, open ONE case with the Federal Service Desk, quoting the reference number. Never start a second registration to get around a stall.

5. Renewal calendar

The registration expires 365 days after it goes Active, and the lapse is silent. Set these the day you go Active, one set per entity. See Chapter 12.

Entity

Legal business name

UEI

The dates

Active date

Expiration (Active + 365)

Weekend? The Friday before

Reminder 1 (60 days out)

Reminder 2 (30 days out)

Reminder 1: 'Start SAM renewal'. Reminder 2: 'SAM renewal NOT DONE'. Renewal is free, re-runs validation, and can stall the way the original did. If reminder 2 fires and it is not done, that is the day to open a service desk case.

Changes that must be updated when they happen, not at renewal

- ☐ New physical address
- ☐ Change of legal name
- ☐ Change of ownership or control
- ☐ New bank account (keep the old one open until the first payment lands)

What the genuine reminder looks like

SAM.gov sends several email reminders before expiration, from a .gov address, to the email on your Login.gov account. They tell you to sign in at sam.gov. They never carry a fee, a phone number to call, or a deadline shorter than the expiration date you wrote above.

6. Is this letter from the government?

Keep this wherever the business mail lands. Four questions, in order. See Chapter 12 and Appendix G.

1. Does it ask for money?

The government charges nothing for registration, renewal, a UEI, a CAGE code, or any certificate. Any dollar amount means it is not from the government. Stop here.

2. Where does it come from?

Government mail about SAM comes from a .gov address. Read any web address from the right-hand end: the last part before the first single slash is who you are talking to. 'sam.gov' is the government. 'sam-gov-renewals.com' and 'sam.gov.verify.example.com' are not.

3. What does it want you to do?

Genuine reminders tell you to sign in at sam.gov. They do not ask you to call a number, reply with information, click to 'activate', or scan a code.

4. Does knowing your UEI, CAGE or registration date prove anything?

No. Those are on your public record by design. A letter that quotes them has read the registry, not come from it.

GSA's own list: SAM.gov will never

- ☐ Ask for personal information anywhere except within SAM.gov itself
- ☐ Ask for money or threaten legal action or liability
- ☐ Ask you to call or text anybody
- ☐ Send a link that doesn't end in .gov
- ☐ Advertise on social media

What to do with the rest

Nothing. Don't call, reply, or click. To report it: reportfraud.ftc.gov, ic3.gov, or the GSA Inspector General hotline at gsaig.gov. Then renew your own registration, yourself, at sam.gov, in the window on worksheet 5.

Log the ones you receive

Date / sender / the tell

Date / sender / the tell

Date / sender / the tell

Date / sender / the tell

7. Your state, your entity type

The federal half of this process - Login.gov, SAM.gov, the IRS check, the CAGE code - is the same everywhere. The state half is not. Fill this page in once, from your own state's filing office. See Appendix H.

Find your state's office by searching your state's name plus 'division of corporations' or 'Secretary of State business filing'. Confirm the address ends in .gov before entering anything.

Your filing office

Office name _____

Entity search URL (.gov) _____

Good-standing doc name _____

The numbers

Formation fee _____

Certified copy of articles _____

Certificate of status _____

Annual or biennial report fee _____

Late penalty _____

The dates

Separate effective date? _____

Report deadline _____

Certificate valid until _____

Banks commonly want the certificate file-stamped within 60 days. A slow account application can outlive one; re-order if it does.

Entity type - what changes in SAM

- ☐ LLC / corporation: state of incorporation = the forming state; start year from the filing
- ☐ Sole proprietor: no state; start year = when you began; get an EIN anyway; evidence is a license, bank statement or utility bill
- ☐ Non-profit: expect to be asked for the IRS determination letter; choose All Awards if you will ever contract
- ☐ Foreign entity: NCAGE first ONLY if seeking Department of Defense awards

Registered agent

Who is your agent _____

- ☐ The agent's address is NOT the physical address SAM wants